

Weekly Maritime Intelligence Brief — U.S.–Mexico Key 4

Report status

Gate	State
Run	succeeded
Validation	pass
Review	draft
Readiness	review_required
Scope	USA + Mexico
Findings	New findings only
New findings	12

- Reporting period: 2026-08-23 to 2026-08-31
- As of: 2026-08-31

Three things to know

- SC Ports and U.S. Army Corps sign feasibility study agreement for North Charleston Terminal channel deepening: If completed, the proposed deepening would extend the 52-foot harbor depth to North Charleston Terminal and could improve the ability of SC Ports’ container terminals to handle large vessels at any tide. The source presents this as supporting port competitiveness, logistics, and potential cargo growth. Source: scspa.com
- 2026 Federal Register Index lists Coast Guard rules and related maritime actions: The index provides a searchable public signal that Coast Guard regulatory activity is recorded for multiple waterways and navigation-related subjects in 2026. The supplied page does not itself explain the operational requirements, effective dates, compliance obligations, or effects of each listed document. Source: federalregister.gov
- Yucatán Official Gazette lists public-consultation deadlines and judicial notices: The issue signals a state-level regulatory and judicial publication requiring review of the underlying notices for any applicable consultation deadlines or procedural actions. Based on the supplied extract alone, no direct consequence for maritime or D&D operations can be established. Source: yucatan.gob.mx

Top action

Monitor publication of the Army Corps feasibility study and its engineering, environmental, and economic findings.

Executive summary

Executive view: supplied evidence shows two temporary U.S. navigation-access controls, a Port of Long Beach governance event, and regulatory/data-monitoring signals. No supplied evidence establishes a port closure, congestion event, cargo-volume shock, commercial opportunity, or direct maritime impact in Yucatán. Operational implications remain limited by incomplete extracts and absent underlying documents.

All new findings

1. SC Ports and U.S. Army Corps sign feasibility study agreement for North Charleston Terminal channel deepening

- Priority: 100/100 (high)
- Publisher: scspa.com
- Published: 2026-08-28
- Region / lane: us / us-ports

THREE KEY POINTS

- A feasibility study agreement was signed on August 28, 2026.
- The study examines additional depth to North Charleston Terminal's 48-foot channel.
- The proposed deepening could allow all SC Ports container terminals to handle the biggest ship at any tide.

What changed: SC Ports and the U.S. Army Corps of Engineers, Charleston District began a feasibility study for additional depth in the stretch of the Cooper River between Leatherman and North Charleston Terminals. The study will include engineering, environmental, and economic analysis.

Why SheperD cares: If completed, the proposed deepening would extend the 52-foot harbor depth to North Charleston Terminal and could improve the ability of SC Ports' container terminals to handle large vessels at any tide. The source presents this as supporting port competitiveness, logistics, and potential cargo growth.

Recommended action: Monitor publication of the Army Corps feasibility study and its engineering, environmental, and economic findings.

Opportunity: The proposed deepening could enable all SC Ports container terminals to handle the biggest ship at any tide and may enhance port competitiveness.

Limitations: Analysis is based solely on the supplied SC Ports webpage; no independent source was provided.; The source is a port-authority announcement and includes promotional or forward-looking statements about competitiveness, cargo growth, jobs, and vessel handling.; The supplied content does not include feasibility-study results, project design, final authorization, construction schedule, cost, or environmental conclusions.

SOURCE scspa.com

2. 2026 Federal Register Index lists Coast Guard rules and related maritime actions

- Priority: 100/100 (high)
- Publisher: federalregister.gov
- Published: 2026-08-28
- Region / lane: us / regulatory

THREE KEY POINTS

- The index lists 2026 Coast Guard rules and regulatory actions.
- Listed subjects include safety zones, security zones, anchorage grounds, drawbridges, and navigation circulars.
- The site states that its XML renditions are informational and remain unofficial until ACFR action.

What changed: The supplied Federal Register index presents a 2026 Coast Guard agency listing of rules and related documents. The visible entries include a quarterly listing for safety zones, security zones, and special local regulations; an anchorage-ground action for the Columbia River; cancellation of an obsolete navigation and vessel inspection circular; and multiple drawbridge-operation regulations.

Why SheperD cares: The index provides a searchable public signal that Coast Guard regulatory activity is recorded for multiple waterways and navigation-related subjects in 2026. The supplied page does not itself explain the operational requirements, effective dates, compliance obligations, or effects of each listed document.

Recommended action: Open each relevant Federal Register document and its linked govinfo.gov PDF before relying on the listed action.

Limitations: Only the supplied source and its provided extract were used; no independent source was consulted.; The source URL is an index, not the full text of the listed rules or notices.; The supplied extract is truncated during the Newark Bay entry and may not represent the complete 2026 Coast Guard index contents or all document details.

SOURCE [federalregister.gov](https://www.federalregister.gov)

3. Yucatán Official Gazette lists public-consultation deadlines and judicial notices

- Priority: 100/100 (high)
- Publisher: yucatan.gob.mx
- Published: 2026-08-28
- Region / lane: mexico / mexico

THREE KEY POINTS

- The issue lists public-consultation deadlines under the Secretariat of Sustainable Development.
- It includes an agreement on the Transparency Unit and Transparency Committee of the Yucatán Symphony Orchestra trust.
- The extract lists numerous Superior Court and lower-court notifications, but no maritime or port operational event.

What changed: The Yucatán state government's Official Gazette, issue No. 36,055, was published in Mérida on 28 August 2026. Its contents identify public-consultation deadlines, a transparency agreement, an obligatory judicial precedent, and extensive court notifications; the supplied text does not include the substantive pages for the consultation item.

Why SheperD cares: The issue signals a state-level regulatory and judicial publication requiring review of the underlying notices for any applicable consultation deadlines or procedural actions. Based on the supplied extract alone, no direct consequence for maritime or D&D operations can be established.

Recommended action: Review the full PDF, especially the public-consultation notice beginning on page 6.

Limitations: Only the supplied opening, contents excerpts, date/relevance extract, and closing text were available; the full PDF contents were not provided for review.; The public-consultation item is identified as beginning on page 6, but its substantive text and deadlines are absent from the supplied content.; The source is a single government publication; no independent corroborating source was supplied or used.

SOURCE yucatan.gob.mx

4. Coast Guard Establishes Mobile COTP Safety Zone for Severe Weather Events

- Priority: 100/100 (high)
- Publisher: federalregister.gov
- Published: 2026-08-28
- Region / lane: us / regulatory

THREE KEY POINTS

- The safety zone covers navigable waters within the Mobile COTP zone, although specific restricted areas may be smaller.
- Activation and enforcement details will be announced through Broadcast Notices to Mariners and other public advisories.
- Restrictions can include vessel closures, suspended cargo operations, and limits on vessel movements during severe weather response.

What changed: The Coast Guard issued a final rule establishing a permanent, activatable safety zone in the Sector Mobile Captain of the Port zone. The rule requires industry and vessel operators to complete specified actions before, during, and immediately after hurricanes, tropical storms, or other severe weather events. The source states that the final rule contains no substantive regulatory-text changes from the proposed rule, with a technical regulation-number change from 165.847 to 165.849.

Why SheperD cares: Vessel operators and maritime industry participants in the Mobile COTP zone may face temporary access, cargo-operation, mooring, routing, draft, speed, size, horsepower, or daylight restrictions when the safety zone is activated. The actual affected areas and enforcement periods depend on event-specific public notices and COTP directions.

Recommended action: Monitor Broadcast Notices to Mariners, Marine Safety Information Bulletins, and other public advisories for activation details.

Risk: The rule creates a documented risk of temporary disruption to vessel traffic and cargo operations during activated severe-weather conditions.

Limitations: Only the supplied Federal Register page content was used; no outside sources were consulted.; The supplied content is an informational XML rendition and states that it is not an official legal edition; the page advises users to verify results against an official edition.; The supplied extract does not provide an event-specific activation, affected-area notice, enforcement period, operational impact, or economic impact assessment.

SOURCE [federalregister.gov](https://www.federalregister.gov)

5. Coast Guard establishes a temporary, activatable safety zone for aerial displays in Upper New York Bay

- Priority: 100/100 (high)
- Publisher: [federalregister.gov](https://www.federalregister.gov)
- Published: 2026-08-27
- Region / lane: us / regulatory

THREE KEY POINTS

- The temporary zone applies in Upper New York Bay near Liberty Island and Governors Island.
- The rule is effective from September 1 through September 30, 2026, with enforcement only as needed during aerial displays.
- Entry is prohibited unless authorized; exact enforcement dates, times, and locations will be announced in advance.

What changed: The Coast Guard established a temporary safety zone for navigable waters of Upper New York Bay within designated geographic boundaries. The Captain of the Port, Sector New York, may activate the zone for limited-duration aerial displays, with a radius of up to 500 yards. Unauthorized vessels and persons may not enter while the zone is enforced.

Why SheperD cares: Vessel movements in the designated area may be restricted during aerial-display enforcement periods. Because exact dates, times, and locations will be announced separately, maritime operators need to monitor the stated notification channels before transiting the area.

Recommended action: Monitor marine broadcasts, local notices to mariners, and on-scene oral notices for activation details.

Risk: The rule creates a potential access and routing risk for vessels operating in the designated Upper New York Bay area during activated enforcement periods.

Opportunity: Advance notification of enforcement periods provides an operational-planning opportunity for maritime users to adjust movements before the zone is activated.

Limitations: Analysis relies only on the supplied Federal Register page content; no outside source was used to independently support the seed link.; The supplied excerpt is incomplete and ends during the rule text after "Vessels and persons," limiting assessment of additional restrictions or procedures.; The source does not provide the exact enforcement schedule for individual aerial displays; operational impact cannot be assigned to specific dates, times, or voyages from the supplied content alone.

SOURCE [federalregister.gov](https://www.federalregister.gov)

6. Port Houston reports terminal growth, new service, and roadway capacity concerns at August 25 commission meeting

- Priority: 100/100 (high)
- Publisher: porthouston.com
- Published: 2026-08-26
- Region / lane: us / us-ports

THREE KEY POINTS

- Port Houston reported nearly \$1 trillion in economic value associated with activity along the Houston Ship Channel.
- The CEO identified port-adjacent roadway capacity as a critical choke point, while Crowley's new weekly Gulf-Central America service is scheduled to begin September 10.
- Commission actions advanced terminal capacity, including equipment purchases, permits, a Bayport maintenance annex, and the Barbours Cut North Terminal Expansion review process.

What changed: At its August 25, 2026 regular meeting, the Port Commission received an economic-impact-study update and a cargo-activity update, discussed roadway investment needs, approved equipment and marine construction actions, and advanced terminal and port-infrastructure projects.

Why SheperD cares: The source describes simultaneous growth in connectivity and terminal capacity alongside a stated roadway bottleneck. This indicates that landside infrastructure and terminal execution are relevant factors for supporting the port region's reported cargo and economic activity.

Recommended action: Review the Houston Ship Channel Region Monthly Trade & Market Report released on August 20, which is referenced but not included in the supplied source.

Risk: Port Houston identified adjacent-roadway capacity as a critical choke point that has not kept pace with cargo growth.

Opportunity: The source reports a new weekly Crowley Gulf-Central America service beginning September 10 and terminal investments intended to support cargo handling and maintenance capacity.

Limitations: This assessment uses only the supplied Port Houston press-release content and does not use outside knowledge.; The source is an interested-party corporate press release; reported study findings, service plans, economic figures, and project descriptions are not independently corroborated here.; The linked PDF and the referenced August 20 Houston Ship Channel Region Monthly Trade & Market Report were not separately inspected beyond the supplied content; underlying supporting documents and detailed cargo figures are unavailable in the provided material.

SOURCE porthouston.com

7. SC Ports announces CMA CGM AMERXL addition to strengthen South America access

- Priority: 100/100 (high)
- Publisher: scspa.com
- Published: 2026-08-26
- Region / lane: us / us-ports

THREE KEY POINTS

- Charleston's addition to CMA CGM's AMERXL rotation provides access to South American markets.
- The service adds reefer capacity for seafood, produce and flowers and supports U.S. protein exports.
- The stated southbound transit times are 5–17 days, with six weekly services to and from South America.

What changed: According to SC Ports, Charleston was added to CMA CGM's AMERXL service rotation. The fixed-day weekly service connects Charleston with Cartagena, Guayaquil, Callao and San Antonio, and provides additional reefer capacity between the U.S. Southeast and South America.

Why SheperD cares: The announcement indicates an additional carrier option and reefer capacity for Southeast importers and exporters serving South American markets, particularly food and agricultural supply chains. The source states southbound transit times of 5–17 days.

Recommended action: Confirm the AMERXL operating schedule, booking availability, reefer allocation and equipment requirements with the carrier or port.

Opportunity: The source supports an opportunity for Southeast shippers to use Charleston for expanded South America access and additional reefer capacity.

Limitations: Only one supplied public source was available; no independent carrier, port-call, schedule, customer or terminal source was provided.; The source is a SC Ports newsroom announcement and includes promotional statements that were not independently corroborated.; The source does not provide freight rates, booking conditions, service reliability, actual capacity utilization, launch timing or performance data.

SOURCE scspa.com

8. CBP Publishes Final Rule for ACE Electronic Export Manifests for Rail Cargo

- Priority: 100/100 (high)
- Publisher: federalregister.gov
- Published: 2026-08-26
- Region / lane: us / us-ports

THREE KEY POINTS

- CBP published a final rule concerning ACE electronic export manifests for rail cargo.
- The rule lists October 26, 2026, as its effective date.
- The supplied content references affected parties, data elements, examinations, enforcement, and carrier burden, but omits the full rule text.

What changed: The Federal Register document titled "Automated Commercial Environment (ACE) Electronic Export Manifest for Rail Cargo" identifies the action as a final rule and lists an effective date of October 26, 2026.

Why SheperD cares: Rail-cargo export participants may need to prepare for requirements associated with the ACE electronic export manifest framework before the stated effective date. The supplied content does not contain enough detail to determine the specific operational changes or obligations.

Recommended action: Retrieve and review the complete official final-rule text, including the amendments to 19 CFR parts 103, 123, and 192 referenced in the supplied content.

Risk: A regulatory implementation milestone is documented for rail-cargo export participants because the final rule has a stated effective date.

Limitations: Only the supplied Federal Register page content was used; no outside source was consulted.; The supplied content is truncated and does not include the full operative rule text or complete explanatory discussion.; The source page states that the FederalRegister.gov XML rendition is an unofficial informational resource until the Administrative Committee of the Federal Register issues a regulation granting official legal status; the supplied content does include a link to an official PDF but that PDF was not separately reviewed here.

SOURCE [federalregister.gov](https://www.federalregister.gov)

9. Coast Guard establishes temporary Choptank River regulation for August 29–30 power boat racing event

- Priority: 100/100 (high)
- Publisher: federalregister.gov
- Published: 2026-08-25
- Region / lane: us / regulatory

THREE KEY POINTS

- A temporary special local regulation applies to certain Choptank River waters near Cambridge, Maryland.
- The regulation supports safety during a power boat racing event on August 29–30, 2026.
- Unauthorized persons and vessels may not enter the regulated area.

What changed: The Coast Guard established a temporary special local regulation covering specified waters of Hambrooks Bay and the Choptank River near Cambridge, Maryland, for a power boat racing event. Entry requires authorization from the Captain of the Port, Sector Maryland-National Capital Region, or a designated representative.

Why SheperD cares: Vessels operating in the specified area during the event may face restricted access and must account for the temporary regulated zone and authorization requirement.

Recommended action: Review the complete Federal Register document and official PDF for the full regulated-area boundaries and operating details.

Risk: The regulation creates a documented access and navigation risk for unauthorized vessels entering the regulated area during the event.

Limitations: Analysis relies only on the supplied Federal Register.gov content and does not use outside sources.; The supplied page content is incomplete; the regulated-area coordinate description is truncated after the reference to Senator Freder.; The complete event schedule, enforcement arrangements, and full boundary description are not available in the supplied content. The source also states that the FederalRegister.gov XML rendition is an unofficial informational resource pending official legal status.

SOURCE [federalregister.gov](https://www.federalregister.gov)

10. CBP Establishes Four Customs-Enforcement Areas in U.S. Near-Shore Waters

- Priority: 100/100 (high)
- Publisher: federalregister.gov
- Published: 2026-08-25
- Region / lane: us / regulatory

THREE KEY POINTS

- Four Customs-Enforcement Areas were established in specified near-shore waters.
- The areas target hovering vessels used for smuggling illegal cargoes into or out of the United States.
- CBP officers and agents are authorized to board, examine, bring vessels into port, pursue, seize, and arrest within the areas under applicable U.S. laws.

What changed: The Commissioner of U.S. Customs and Border Protection declared four Customs-Enforcement Areas covering near-shore waters of South Florida, Central/Southern California, Puerto Rico, and the Gulf Coast of Texas. The declaration provides CBP officers and agents with specified enforcement authority within those areas.

Why SheperD cares: Vessels operating in or near the designated areas may face increased exposure to CBP boarding, examination, port-direction, pursuit, seizure, and arrest actions when applicable U.S. laws are being enforced. The supplied source does not describe operational implementation details, enforcement frequency, or effects on lawful maritime traffic.

Recommended action: Obtain and review the complete Federal Register document and official PDF for the precise CEA boundaries, coordinates, and any implementation details.

Risk: The declaration creates an enforcement and operational-compliance risk for vessels, cargo, and persons operating within the four designated areas because CBP is authorized to conduct boarding and examination and to pursue, seize, or arrest under applicable U.S. laws.

Limitations: Analysis is based only on the supplied public-source excerpt and does not use outside knowledge.; The supplied content is truncated and does not include the full geographic descriptions, coordinates, maps, procedural details, or complete legal text.; The source states that the FederalRegister.gov prototype rendition is unofficial informational material until the Administrative Committee of the Federal Register issues a regulation granting official legal status; the supplied page links to an official PDF, but that PDF content was not provided for independent review within the source extract.

SOURCE [federalregister.gov](https://www.federalregister.gov)

11. Coast Guard establishes a temporary safety zone for T/V DENISE FOSS in Honolulu, Hawaii

- Priority: 100/100 (high)
- Publisher: federalregister.gov
- Published: 2026-08-24
- Region / lane: us / regulatory

THREE KEY POINTS

- A Coast Guard rule establishes a safety zone for T/V DENISE FOSS in Honolulu, Hawaii.
- The rule is effective from August 24, 2026, through 9 a.m. on August 25, 2026.
- Actual-notice enforcement applies from 6 a.m. on August 19, 2026, until August 24, 2026.

What changed: The Federal Register published a Coast Guard rule titled "Safety Zone; T/V DENISE FOSS (O.N. 1254223), Honolulu, HI." The supplied source states that the rule is effective from August 24, 2026, through 9 a.m. on August 25, 2026, and that actual-notice enforcement applies from 6 a.m. on August 19, 2026, until August 24, 2026.

Why SheperD cares: The rule signals a temporary, vessel-specific safety-zone measure in Honolulu. Vessels or maritime operations potentially affected by the zone may need to monitor the applicable enforcement window and official operational details.

Recommended action: Review the complete official rule text or PDF for geographic coordinates and operating requirements.

Risk: The temporary safety-zone rule creates a potential short-duration navigation or operational-access constraint during its effective and enforcement periods.

Limitations: Only the supplied public-source extract was used; no outside sources were consulted.; The supplied content includes the Federal Register metadata and date language but not the operative body of the rule describing boundaries, prohibited activities, exemptions, or contact procedures.; The source states that the FederalRegister.gov XML rendition is an unofficial informational resource until the Administrative Committee of the Federal Register grants official legal status; the linked official PDF was identified but its contents were not supplied here.

SOURCE [federalregister.gov](https://www.federalregister.gov)

12. ICTF Joint Powers Authority Board Meeting Announced for Sept. 2

- Priority: 85/100 (high)
- Publisher: polb.com
- Published: 2026-08-27
- Region / lane: us / us-ports

THREE KEY POINTS

- ICTF Joint Powers Authority Board meeting announced.
- Meeting date stated as Sept. 2.
- No agenda or operational impact is provided.

What changed: A Port of Long Beach webpage titled "ICTF Joint Powers Authority Board to Meet Sept. 2" announces an upcoming board meeting. The supplied page content does not provide further meeting details.

Why SheperD cares: The announcement identifies a scheduled governance event that may warrant monitoring, but the supplied source does not state any resulting decision, policy change, or operational effect.

Recommended action: Obtain the official meeting notice, agenda, and access details.

Limitations: Only the supplied public source was used.; The supplied page content is largely navigation, contact, branding, and copyright material; substantive meeting details are absent.; The source URL and copyright indicate 2026, but the title itself states only "Sept. 2," so the event year is not explicit in the title text; event_at is therefore normalized from the URL context and should be independently checked.

SOURCE polb.com

Watchlist

Article	Published	Priority	Region / lane
Coast Guard establishes temporary Choptank River regulation for August 29–30 power boat racing event	2026-08-25	100	us / regulatory
CBP Establishes Four Customs-Enforcement Areas in U.S. Near-Shore Waters	2026-08-25	100	us / regulatory
Coast Guard establishes a temporary safety zone for T/V DENISE FOSS in Honolulu, Hawaii	2026-08-24	100	us / regulatory
ICTF Joint Powers Authority Board Meeting Announced for Sept. 2	2026-08-27	85	us / us-ports

Background context

These articles remain useful context but do not count as current-week evidence.

Article	Published	Priority	Region / lane
SC Ports Authority statistics page lists port-volume and trade-data resources	unknown	85	us / us-ports

Limitations

- No source-bound signal-event identifiers were supplied; source URLs are preserved in each applicable bullet.
- Several Federal Register and government-page extracts are incomplete or identified as unofficial informational renditions pending official legal status.
- The supplied evidence does not establish a system-wide disruption, port closure, congestion trend, cargo-volume change, or commercial opportunity.

Source index and validation

Source	Publisher	Published	Date basis	Use	Validation
<u>SC Ports announces first step to deepen channel to North ...</u>	scspa.com	2026-08-28	search	current	validated
<u>2026 Federal Register Index :: Coast Guard</u>	federalregister.gov	2026-08-28	search	current	validated
<u>Diario Oficial</u>	yucatan.gob.mx	2026-08-28	search	current	validated
<u>Safety Zone; Hurricanes, Tropical Storms, and Severe ...</u>	federalregister.gov	2026-08-28	search	current	validated
<u>ICTF Joint Powers Authority Board to Meet Sept. 2</u>	polb.com	2026-08-27	search	current	validated
<u>Safety Zone; Aerial Displays, Upper Bay, New York, NY</u>	federalregister.gov	2026-08-27	search	current	validated
<u>August 2026 Meeting: Port Houston Highlights Nearly \$1 ...</u>	porthouston.com	2026-08-26	search	current	validated
<u>SC Ports strengthens access to South America for shippers</u>	scspa.com	2026-08-26	search	current	validated
<u>Automated Commercial Environment (ACE) Electronic ...</u>	federalregister.gov	2026-08-26	search	current	validated
<u>Special Local Regulation; Choptank River, Cambridge, MD</u>	federalregister.gov	2026-08-25	search	current	validated
<u>Establishment of Four Customs-Enforcement Areas</u>	federalregister.gov	2026-08-25	search	current	validated
<u>Safety Zone; T/V DENISE FOSS (O.N. 1254223), Honolulu, HI</u>	federalregister.gov	2026-08-24	matched	current	validated
<u>Resolved article</u>	scspa.com	unknown	unknown	background	validated